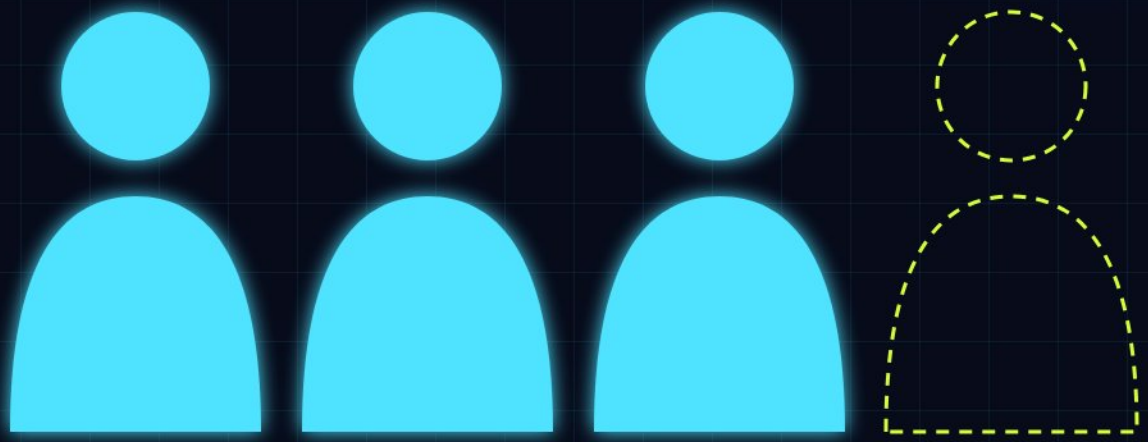
Microsoft just offered 60,000 people a way out.

About 1 in 4 employees, while it plans **$175bn** of AI infrastructure spend in 2026.



What does it mean for Grade A offices?



Gabriele Maffezzini
Project & Development, EMEA

Source: CBS News, 26 Oct 2026. Microsoft headcount 223,000 (June 2026)

Fewer people, fewer desks.
Better buildings.

Big tech is funding AI by trimming headcount, yet the best offices keep filling up.

49,000
desks Amazon plans to cut in 2026

~88,000
US job losses in 2026 linked to AI

52%
of 2025 European leasing was Grade A, a record

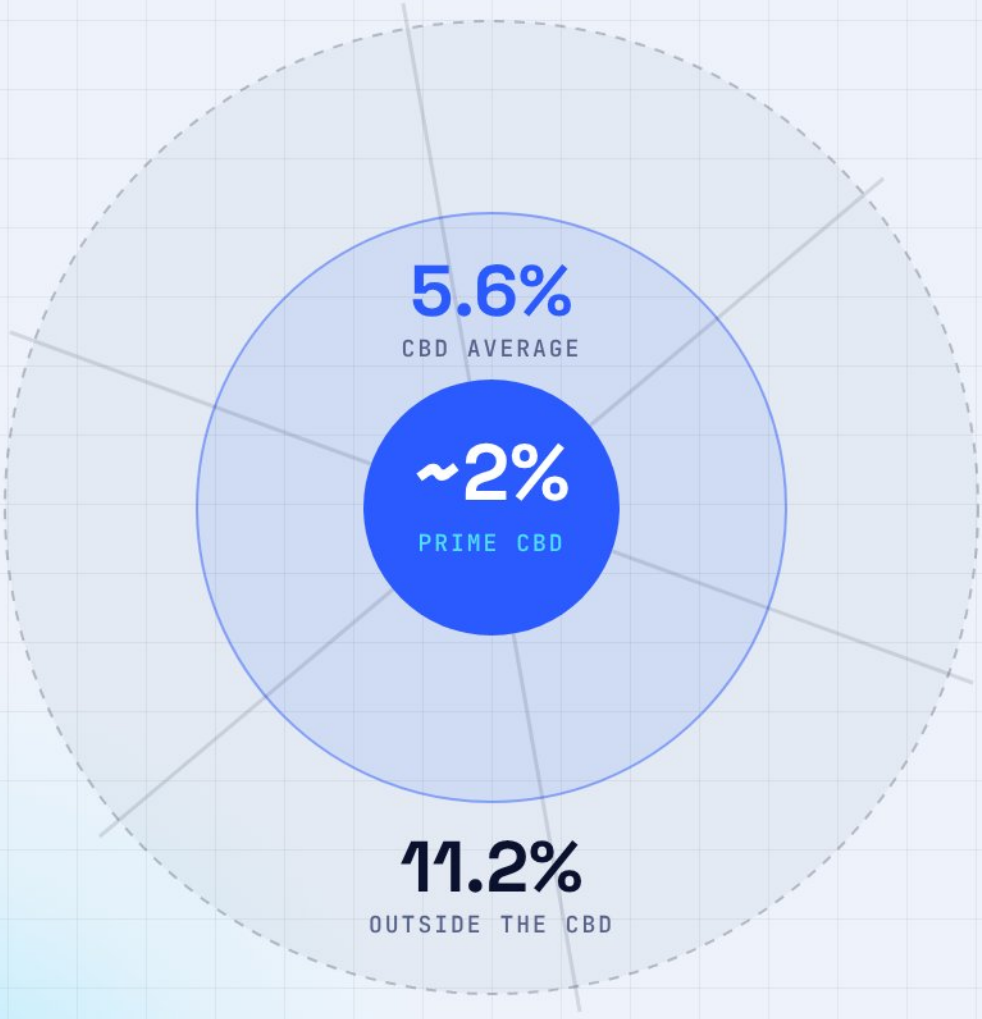
3.5%
vacancy left in Grade A buildings



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Sources: Puget Sound Business Journal via KIRO 7; Challenger, Gray & Christmas; Cushman & Wakefield, European Office Update, Mar 2026

The centre fills up.
The edge empties.





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Source: European office market research, Q1 2026 (13 CBD markets)

Offices are becoming hotels and homes.



17%
of CBD office purchases in H1 2026 were for conversion

14 yrs
highest share since 2012; 12% in 2022

70%+
of known conversions go to homes and hotels



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Source: MSCI Real Capital Analytics, Aug 2026 (CBD deals above EUR 5m)

The AI boom is a power boom.



POWER FIRST, THEN SPACE

12.1 GW
data centre capacity live in EMEA, H1 2026

18.3 GW
in construction or planning

+34%
pipeline growth, year on year



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Source: Cushman & Wakefield, EMEA Data Centre update, H1 2026

Fewer desks. Higher stakes per square metre.

Smaller
sized to real attendance

Central
close to transport and clients

Mixed use
office, hotel, homes together

Convertible
ready for a second life

Will AI shrink Grade A offices, or make them more valuable?

Tell me what you see in your market.



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